Why should great people meet with such horrific ends? I recol ected my father tel ing someone in a similar context: “Good and bad people live together under the sun as the black thread and the white are woven together in a cloth. When either one of the black or white thread breaks, the weaver shal look into the whole cloth, and he shal examine the loom also.” When I drove out of the laboratory there was not a single soul on the road. I kept thinking about the loom of the broken thread.

Shrimati Gandhi’s death was a tremendous loss to the scientific community. She had given impetus to scientific research in the country. But India is a very resilient nation. It gradual y absorbed the shock of Shrimati Gandhi’s assassination, although at the cost of thousands of lives and a colossal loss of property. Her son, Rajiv Gandhi, took over as the new Prime Minister of India. He went to the pol s and obtained a mandate from the people to carry forward the policies of Mrs. Gandhi, the Integrated Guided Missile Development Programme being a part of them.

By the summer of 1985, al the groundwork had been completed for building the Missile Technology Research Centre at Imarat Kancha. Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi laid